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원문 제목	University of Illinois study finds fertilizer industry consolidation is a key hidden driver of high prices
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검색 키워드	University of Illinois fertilizer consolidation hidden driver 46 to 13 producers 72% four firms 75% nitrogen market 15.3% expense increase DOJ antitrust Nutrien Mosaic CF Koch Yara duopoly class action
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카드 요약 / 당시 확인 내용

A University of Illinois study finds fertilizer industry consolidation is a key hidden driver of high prices. U.S. nitrogen fertilizer producers dropped from 46 to 13 between 1984 and 2008, a 72% reduction, and four companies now control approximately 75% of the domestic nitrogen market. U.S. farmers faced a 15.3% increase in fertilizer expenses in 2026, and the consolidated market structure gives producers significant pricing power. The DOJ antitrust division is investigating Nutrien, Mosaic, CF Industries, Koch and Yara for potential pricing violations, and two class - action lawsuits have been filed by farmers alleging coordinated production cuts to inflate prices. USDA Deputy Secretary Stephen Vaden characterized North American producers as a duopoly. The research indicates geopolitical shocks and energy costs explain temporary spikes, but the concentrated structure amplifies their effects and slows price recovery, suggesting structural reform may be necessary alongside supply normalization.